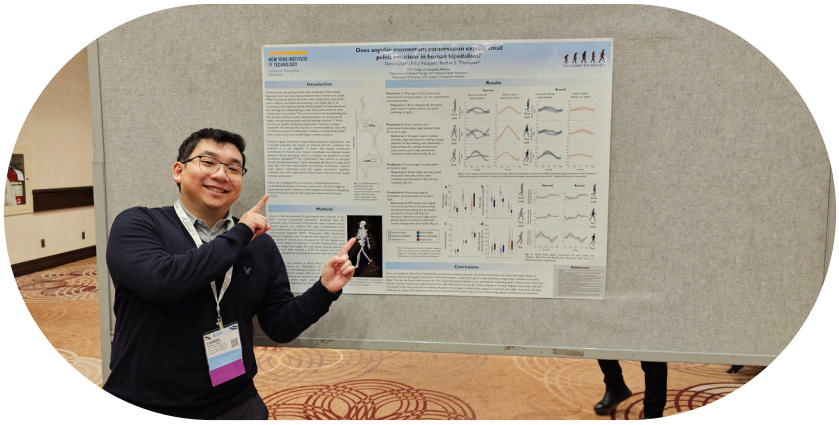
2023/2024
ANNUAL REPORT

EDWARD GUILIANO GLOBAL FELLOWSHIPS







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EDWARD GUILIANO GLOBAL FELLOWSHIPS

Since 2014, the Edward Guiliano Global Fellowship program generously awarded 208 New York Institute of Technology students the opportunity to broaden their perspectives and interact with the larger world through academic and cultural experiences. Through experiential-based learning outside their community and comfort zones, students have grown personally and professionally during their fellowships.

Open to ALL New York Tech students, these fellowships encourage students to:

- Engage in research or artistically expressive, innovative projects around the world
- Present original findings or work at conferences and symposiums
- Support ideas to produce novel solutions or creative content

2023-2024 Snapshot

During the 2023-2024 academic year, 11 students were able to take advantage of funding provided by the Edward Guiliano Global Fellowship program. These students came from New York Institute of Technology's Long Island, New York City, Jonesboro, and Vancouver campuses. The students visited nine countries on five continents.

Program Highlights

Academic Year 2023-2024 brought continued growth, development and promotion to the fellowship. Notable highlights include:

- A 58% increase in applications: Summer/Fall 2023 saw 36 applicants and Winter/Spring 2024 saw 56 applicants (a total of 92 applicants in the academic year), compared to AY 22-23's total of 58 applicants.
- Enhanced application design during Winter 2024 intersession - focused on more concise questions and clearer descriptions of Fellowship demands in order to increase quality of submissions and data gathered on applicants. It was first implemented for the Summer/Fall 24 application cycle.
- More rigorous selection process: stricter adherence to fellowship guidelines and a more robust and diverse selection committee - 12 members made up of faculty, staff and a former fellow.
- New branded merch with new logo; improved travel folders and luggage tags.
- "Edward Guiliano Global Fellowship Homecoming" planning for Fall 2024 is underway for all former New York Tech, Brown, Stony Brook, and MLA Fellows to network, share their projects and meet Edward. Official Save the Date announcements have been sent.
- Official website is now live: https://guilianofellows.org/

EDWARD GUILIANO
GLOBAL FELLOWSHIPS

Summer/Fall 2023

There were five Summer/Fall 2023 Fellowships for a total of $21,000.
Following are updates from those fellows:

Melody Young & Noah Chernik





Major: Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine '26
Campus: Long Island
Project Title: *Across the Pacific: STEM Initiative in Mongolia*
Project Location: Mongolia
Dates: 8/8/2023 - 8/23/2023
Project Description:
(Melody)
The purpose of this project was to create a lasting partnership between NYIT and The Institute for the Study of Mongolian Dinosaurs (ISMD), a 501(c)(3) nonprofit corporation in the United States since 2016. I was invited by paleontologist Bolortsetseg Minjin, the founder of the Institute for the Study of Mongolian Dinosaurs, a 501c3 nonprofit organization based in the United States to accompany them to various provinces across northwestern Mongolia to speak with, educate, and inspire school aged children (elementary, middle, and high school). I took a lab-born outreach program "Are You Stronger Than a Lemur", which has been a huge success here in the States and I took it international! Working with native Mongolian interpreters, I was able to educate the students about biomechanics, statistics, muscle physiology, primatology, and evolution and then allowed the students to become scientists themselves and collect data that we will eventually use in a scientific paper! I've had so much fun working with the students in Mongolia, learning about their culture, and quite honestly taking in the tremendous landscapes and lifestyle.

I think the most important thing I learned was adaptability. My second leg of the departure trip from Istanbul, Turkey to Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia was delayed ~28 hours. During that time, we were deboarded from the plane twice and there was no clarity whether or not this flight would actually depart. Through that wild experience, there was doubt as to if I'd make it to Mongolia on time to start the project, and a true test of my patience with the air service staff. I learned that there are a lot of things out of my control, and that sometimes, even if the trip was planned to the tee, unexpected things come up and must be dealt with.

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Melody Young & Noah Chernik





Major: Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine '26
Campus: Long Island
Project Title: *Are you Stronger than a Lemur? - Mongolia Edition*
Project Location: Mongolia
Dates: 8/8/2023 - 8/23/2023
Project Description:

(Noah)

The purpose of our travel to Mongolia was to provide hands-on in-person STEM outreach to students throughout the northwest provinces of Mongolia. Traveling with the Institute for the Study of Mongolian Dinosaurs (IMSD), a 501(c)(3) non-profit, we traveled to three different cities (Kharkhorin of Övörkhangai Province, Tsetserleg of Arkhangai Province, Tosontsengel of Zavkhan Province). Additionally, through these outreach events, we hoped to network and make new connections for the NYITCOM penpal program, which is run by Melody Young and myself.

This trip was truly a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity. Since being home, I have found it very hard to answer the question "How was your trip?" because a simple "good" does not suffice. While it was stressful, tackling hundreds of unknowns halfway around the world, it opened my eyes to an entirely different culture. I was able to interact with people who hold many different values compared to myself. Despite this, we were still able to find common ground, mostly through our shared love of learning. Personally, this trip has greatly increased my own personal growth. There were many times when I doubted if this trip was a good idea, if missing a week of medical school for this trip was worth it, and if I could even handle being so far out of my comfort zone. With the help of my family, and the people I traveled through Mongolia with, I learned how to handle the stressors of the unknown, and simply go with the flow. With this trip under my belt, I feel a renewed sense of self confidence in terms of my personal limits. On the flight from JFK to Istanbul, I told myself it was only 2 weeks, and then I would be back home where I am comfortable. By the flight home, I was already brainstorming how we could continue to expand this fantastic outreach event to more countries and continents. Without the help of the Edward Guiliano Global Fellowship, this trip never would have become a reality, and I would not have grown as a scholar, educator, future physician, and, most importantly, a human.

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Hatice Gazioglu

Major: Masters of Business Administration '25
Campus: New York City
Project Title: *Empowering Bayburt: Improving Education for Communities Affected by the Earthquake*
Project Location: Turkey
Dates: 9/4/2023 - 9/25/2023
Project Description:

When the news broke that Turkey had been struck by earthquakes not once, but three times, my heart sank. Thousands of miles away in New York, where I was engrossed in my studies, an overwhelming sense of helplessness consumed me. I yearned to offer solace to my homeland, particularly to those innocent souls who had their worlds shattered overnight. The heartbreak drove me to seek ways in which I could be a beacon of hope and, from these emotions, the idea of PekiCocuk was birthed.

PekiCocuk is not just a tutoring platform; it's a sanctuary of learning, built upon the very aspirations and dreams of the children affected by these tragic earthquakes. I envisioned a space where these children could momentarily forget their sorrows and dive deep into the realms of math, science, literature, and art. More than academics, it's a space for them to heal, connect, and reclaim their disrupted lives.

During the Fellowship experience, I learned the profound impact of community-centric initiatives, especially in smaller, underserved areas. More than just a project, it underscored the power of returning to one's roots to make a difference. Beyond the technical aspects, I internalized the importance of resilience, adaptability, and the enduring human spirit in the face of challenges. This journey was a testament to how deeply personal commitment can drive meaningful, sustainable change.

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GLOBAL FELLOWSHIPS

Rachel Feltman



Major: Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine '25
Campus: Long Island
Project Title: *Does Restrictive Abortion Legislation rely on Inaccurate and Misleading Anatomical, Embryological, and Medical Information?*
Project Location: New Orleans, Louisiana
Dates: 10/15/2023 - 10/18/2023
Project Description:
In October 2023 I was invited to present my master's thesis research at the American Society for Reproductive Medicine Scientific Congress and Expo in New Orleans, LA. The goal of my research project was to evaluate the accuracy and level of misleadingness of anatomical, embryological, and medical statements of "fact" within restrictive abortion legislation across the United States. A survey of the statements was created and sent out to anatomists and embryologists across the country where they evaluated each statement based on its level of accuracy and misleadingness. These statements, if inaccurate or misleading, may serve as a vehicle by which misinformation is used to justify laws restricting access to necessary abortion care. By presenting this research at the ASRM conference I was able to provide a new perspective about restrictive abortion legislation and make people question the accuracy of our current legislation.

During my Fellowship experience I learned how important education and knowledge are for advocacy. I not only learned this through giving my talk, but also through listening to presentations on the latest topics and findings within the reproductive medicine field. In order to be an advocate it is crucial to know the facts and stay informed about recent issues. Attending this conference opened my eyes to issues and solutions within the reproductive medicine field that I would not have known otherwise. Gaining this knowledge will make me a stronger advocate for my future patients. Furthermore, I believe my presentation provided attendees with a new perspective and way to think about restrictive abortion legislation which they can hopefully use to advocate for their patients.

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Shikha Gandhi



Major: Bachelor of Architecture ‘26
Campus: New York City
Project Title: *Envisioning the Scope of Amphibious Architecture*
Project Location: Amsterdam, Netherland and India
Dates: 7/15/2023 - 8/25/2023
Project Description:
The project focuses on the use of amphibious architecture as a solution to the flood-prone communities. Kuttanad, in the State of Kerala, has long struggled with the catastrophic effects of monsoons, which cause extensive damage to houses and livelihoods. Despite this struggle, I came upon the brilliant work of Engineer Gopalakrishnan Achari, who created a home that can float on water when floods occur.

Flooding is a global issue that affects nations such as India, the Netherlands, and South Korea. As a result, architecture companies are looking at new ways to secure houses and communities against natural calamities. Achari has reinvented the basis of traditional dwellings in Kuttanad. He replaced the traditional concrete basis with a system of poles and plastic drums, resulting in a more sustainable and environmentally friendly foundation. As a consequence, a 1300 square foot house is intended to float as floodwaters rise.

In conclusion, Kerala provided a fantastic answer to a vexing issue that I learned about during my research trip there. Amphibious architecture, as exemplified by Gopalakrishnan Achari's creative design, provides a ray of hope to populations threatened by flooding. The lessons learnt along the way might pave the way for more robust and sustainable housing alternatives in flood-prone areas throughout the world.

During my fellowship, I gained crucial skills in communication and problem-solving. I also had the chance to learn about diverse cultures, religions, and the local weather and architecture, making it a valuable and enriching experience.

EDWARD GUILIANO
GLOBAL FELLOWSHIPS

Winter/Spring 2024

There were six Winter/Spring 2024 Fellowships for a total of $21,634. Following are updates from those fellows:

Margaret Licata



Major: Master of Art in UX/UI Design and Development '25
Campus: New York City
Project Title: *Accessible Horizons*
Project Location: Copenhagen, Denmark
Dates: 3/17/2024 - 3/24/2024
Project Description:
The heart of this project was the redesign of a grocery shopping app, transforming it into a beacon of accessibility. It was not merely a question of refining a user interface; it was redrawing the entire digital experience to make it truly all-inclusive for a much greater universe of users, including those compromised by conditions such as ALS. An iterative, empathetic process focused on real-world needs and the frustrations my grandmother with ALS would have experienced.

Upon completion of the project, the challenge shifted from creation to dissemination. Now, with my knowledge gained from UXCopenhagen, I'm building a redesigned prototype of a grocery app with tremendous knowledge, which has pushed me to share experiences and findings. This will include a series of workshops and presentations designed for the UX NYIT community and beyond. The success of the series is not only that it is a good example of redesign, but rather a stimulus for discussions of the necessity for inclusivity in digital design. Compiling the research and outcomes into an interactive digital case study serves a dual purpose. The story of this journey its impact will also be a resource for other practitioners in the field. This digital compendium aims to help and inspire more work in accessible design, reflecting the very ideal of the project: empathy and inclusion.

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Nawal Wasif



Major: Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine,
Master of Public Health '25
Campus: Long Island
Project Title: *A Comprehensive Analysis of Barriers for Uro-gynecologic Care in Muslim Women*
Project Location: New England
Dates: 12/15/2023 - 1/12/2024
Project Description:

As a fellow in the Edward Giuliano Global Fellowship, I spent each Friday morning during December 2023 jumping into my car and going on excursions miles into the depths of New England to engage with the elders in my community to discuss and explore what is needed for the betterment of women's health in the Muslim community. As a Muslim woman myself, I can see how my decisions towards women's health can be influenced by many religious and cultural nuances. However, growing up, I was also exposed to the part of the community that was continuously educated on women's health and emphasized the importance of life-saving procedures like annual pap-smears and open-discussions about menstruation. While I am grateful to have been raised with such a positive and supportive understanding of women's health, my interactions with people outside my community made me realize that not everyone has the same understanding and view of women's health, and that as a future healthcare provider, I can use my role to create a supportive environment that educates and inspires women to take lead in their health journeys.

The most significant lesson I gleaned from my Fellowship experience is the profound impact of listening and offering support to underserved communities. Despite their pressing needs, many individuals simply lack the platform or opportunity to voice their challenges and seek assistance. By providing a compassionate ear and extending a helping hand, even in small ways, we can make a meaningful difference in empowering these communities to access the support and resources they require to thrive.

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GLOBAL FELLOWSHIPS

Revanth Dilli



Major: Master of Business Administration - Management ‘24
Campus: New York City
Project Title: *Faecal Sludge Treatment Plant and Sustainability in India*
Project Location: India
Dates: 12/28/2023 - 1/28/2024
Project Description:

Urbanization in India, while fueling economic growth, presents substantial challenges, particularly in sanitation. Open defecation remains a critical concern, impacting public health and environmental sustainability. In this context, Warangal's Faecal Sludge Treatment Plant (FSTP) emerges as a beacon of hope, showcasing a transformative approach to sanitation management. My research delves into the FSTP's innovative journey, exploring its potential to unlock financial sustainability, build market acceptance for resource-derived products, and ultimately serve as a model for replicating successful sanitation solutions across India.

The most significant thing I learned during the Fellowship experience is the power of interdisciplinary collaboration in addressing complex global challenges. By working closely with experts from diverse fields and backgrounds, I gained a deeper appreciation for the interconnectedness of social, environmental, and economic issues. This experience taught me the importance of leveraging multiple perspectives and skill sets to develop innovative and sustainable solutions that have a meaningful impact on communities worldwide.

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Daniel Chan



Major: Osteopathic Medicine ‘26
Campus: Long Island
Project Title: *The Role of Angular Momentum Conservation on Human Bipedalism*
Project Location: Toronto, Canada
Dates: 3/22/2024 - 3/25/2024
Project Description:

At the end of March 2024, I travelled to Toronto, Canada to present my research on evolutionary biomechanics at the Anatomy Connected 2024 Conference by the American Association for Anatomy. My research project explored the role of angular momentum conservation in how humans evolved to move bipedally. To do this, we tried to make humans move more like our facultatively bipedal primate relatives by wearing a brace to interrupt our normal movement patterns to test the theory that we evolved to walk more energetically efficiently and reduced angular momentum. While evolutionary biomechanics may sound like a niche subject, I was surprised by the possibilities of trans-disciplinary applications of my project as many other people from the fields of medicine and physical therapy asked me questions about how my research can be applied to them as many of our physical ailments that develop as we age can stem from how our movement patterns and biomechanics are disrupted with injury and other issues over time.

One of the most significant things that I learned was how to take constructive criticism and feedback at this conference. Normally, at other poster presentations, my audience is one that is not familiar with the kind of science or research that I do, so the only feedback I get is usually superficial and not very impactful for my future directions. Here, most who stopped at my poster and heard me speak about my research were biomechanists themselves who were interested in how my project came to be. With their expertise, I learned a lot about how to move on from my research pitfalls and move out of my own biases and assumptions about my work.

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Chaya Konig



Major: Doctor of Occupational Therapy ‘28
Campus: Long Island
Project Title: My Music - Creating independent play opportunities for children with motor impairments
Project Location: Chicago, Illinois
Dates: 4/11/2024 - 4/14/2024
Project Description:
This program took place from April 11-April 14th, 2024 in Chicago Illinois. Six children (aged two years to seven years) with Canavan’s disease, a neurodegenerative condition, engaged in independent play for the first time. Children with Canavan’s disease have reduced myelin. This severely impacts their motor function. All the participants use wheelchairs and many of them receive nutrition via gastronomy tube. However, cognitive function is often quite high in children with Canavan’s. As such, they seemed to posses an awareness that they were producing the music independently.

Each child attended the session with a parent/caregiver. They were told what would happen and asked if they wanted to try. All children indicated that they did. They were then fitted with the Muse2 headset. They chose from three sets of instruments- electronic, orchestra and classic. The technology was then turned on, and the children started producing music using just their brain waves. Each session lasted for approximately 20-40 minutes. Participants all seemed relaxed during their sessions. They viewed a visual representation of their brain waves on a screen while playing. Some children chose to switch instrument sets during the session while others preferred to use just one set.

Within 2 months after the project took place, semi-structured interviews were conducted with parents of the participants. After each interview, the parent was sent a digital copy of the music that their child produced.

I have a gift and a responsibility. I had the idea for this project for a while. Seeing the results made me realize that it is my responsibility to bring this idea to fruition. Thank you EGGF for making this a reality.

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Ashley McCray

Major: Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine ‘25
Campus: Jonesboro
Project Title: Road to Medicine - A Global Journey
Project Location: Rome and Brazil
Dates: 3/3/2024 - 5/26/2024
Project Description:
Through the Edward Guiliano Fellowship, I was able to participate in the 17th International Research Training Seminar in Child and Adolescent Psychiatry
in Rome, Italy and the 26th world congress of the International Alliance of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry and Allied Professions in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. Both opportunities provided the chance to network and learn from healthcare professionals from all over the world.

While completing the fellowship, my perspective was broadened in the interpersonal interactions I had with seminar and conference participants. In Rome, I roomed with a psychiatrist from England, made a connection with a psychiatrist from Israel, talked about religion with a doctor from Turkey and had the chance to share a lecture hall with 40 individuals from 26 different countries. In Rio de Janeiro, I spent my free time with a psychiatrist from India, a pharmacist in Germany, a psychiatrist in Kenya and got to meet the only child and adolescent psychiatrist in Mozambique. As an added bonus, I got to meet another global-minded medical student from the United States during both experiences in Rome and Rio, one from Texas and one From Michigan, respectively.

One of the most significant things that I learned is that mental health is handled differently everywhere. There is a stigma that has yet to be eradicated surrounding mental health and psychiatry. This is a hinderance to the adequate care of patients because people are reluctant to seek treatment. Seeing so many professionals in one place in Rio and Rome helped me to learn that despite this stigma, there are people in every country who share a common goal of bringing the best treatment to the greatest amount of people. These healthcare professionals are doing whatever they can to help their communities thrive, and I aspire to follow in their footsteps.